

PhD in Finance

Doing PhD Research in Finance

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Outline

1. Introduction to research in finance and developing research questions

- a. Introduction: Overview of the research process
- b. Identifying gaps in research
- c. Literature review
- d. Formulating research questions; data collection and management

2. Writing and presenting findings

- a. Structure of an academic paper
- b. Editing and proofreading
- c. Presentation of research findings

3. The research proposal

4. The PhD defence process at EDHEC

5. Some practical advice and tools for doing research

6. Workshop: Drafting a research proposal

1. Introduction to research in finance and developing research questions



Key Characteristics of Scientific Research

1. Systematic Approach:

- Research follows a structured and organized method to ensure consistency and reliability in the study process.

2. Empirical Evidence:

- Based on observable and measurable data collected through experiments, observations, or other data collection methods.

3. Hypothesis and Theory Development:

- Begins with a hypothesis—a testable prediction or explanation. Research outcomes support or refute the hypothesis, contributing to theory development or modification.

Key Characteristics of Scientific Research

4. Reproducibility and Replicability:

- Research findings should be reproducible by other researchers using the same methods, ensuring that results are not due to chance or specific circumstances.

5. Critical Analysis and Peer Review:

- Research undergoes rigorous evaluation by other experts in the field through a peer review process, ensuring the validity and reliability of the findings.

6. Ethical Considerations:

- Research is conducted with adherence to ethical standards.

Objectives of Research in Finance

- 1. Explain Phenomena:** Explain why and how financial markets behave in certain ways, why entities make specific financial decisions and the underlying causes of financial trends and crises.
 - The 2008 Global Financial Crisis
 - Behavioral finance research to explain investor actions
- 2. Validate Theories:** Through empirical research, theories in finance are tested and validated. This helps refine existing theories or, sometimes, debunk them.
 - Efficient market hypothesis; CAPM and multifactor models
- 3. Predict Market Movements:** Researchers aim to develop models that predict market trends and behaviors, which are crucial for investors, policymakers, and businesses to make informed decisions.
 - ML to predict markets; GARCH models to predict volatility

Objectives of Research in Finance

4. Innovate and Solve Problems: Research pushes the boundaries of what is known and helps in discovering new financial instruments, investment strategies, or risk management tools. It also addresses practical problems, such as improving the efficiency of markets or developing more equitable financial practices.

- Engineering ETFs; Develop VaR models; Creating EFG frameworks

5. Inform Policy and Regulation: Academic research in finance often informs governmental and institutional policies. Effective policies based on robust research can enhance economic stability, regulate financial markets, and protect investors.

- Research explaining the causes of the 2008 crisis directly informed key provisions of the Dodd-Frank Act
- Market microstructure research guides regulations for modern electronic trading.

Identifying Research Gaps

1. Thorough Literature Review

- Start with a comprehensive literature review. Use it to map out the current state of research in your area of interest, noting areas that are well-covered and others that lack sufficient attention or depth.

2. Analyzing Trends and Patterns

- Pay attention to trends and discussions in recent publications. Emerging trends might not yet be thoroughly explored, and shifting paradigms could expose new areas needing investigation.

3. Consulting with Experts

- Discussions with faculty advisors, other PhD students, and professionals in the field can provide insights into unresolved problems and under-researched areas. Conferences, seminars, and academic networks are also valuable for this purpose.

Identifying Research Gaps

4. Methodological Shortcomings

- Look for common criticisms or limitations cited in previous studies. If many studies mention similar limitations, there may be an opportunity to improve the methodology or to apply new methods to old problems.

5. Practical Implications

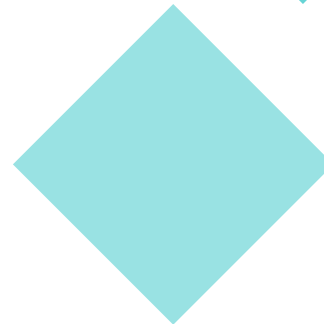
- Consider the practical applications of existing research. If current solutions or theories have limited practical utility, this can highlight gaps worth exploring.

6. Cross-Disciplinary Approaches

- Sometimes, finance research can benefit from theories and methods used in other disciplines like economics, psychology, or data science. Cross-disciplinary gaps can be particularly fruitful areas for research.

Identifying High-Impact Research Gaps

Strategy	Gap Type Identified	Core Question & Example
Methodological Shortcomings	Is the model's foundation flawed?	Black-Scholes' constant volatility assumption was false, leading to GARCH models.
Evidence vs. Theory	Does the data contradict the theory?	The CAPM could not explain "size" and "value" effects, leading to the Fama-French model.
Theory vs. Practice	Why do practitioners ignore the theory?	CFOs prioritize "financial flexibility" over academic models, showing theories are incomplete.
New Trends & Technology	How do we analyze this new phenomenon?	Cryptocurrencies have no cash flows, making traditional valuation models obsolete.
Cross-Disciplinary Lens	Can an outside field challenge core beliefs?	Psychology's Prospect Theory challenged the "rational investor," creating behavioral finance.



Literature Review: Purpose

- **Identify Gaps:** Determine what has been done and what has not been covered in the existing literature.
- **Contextualize the Research:** Show how your work fits into the broader field.
- **Theoretical Framework:** Establish a theoretical basis for your study.
- **Avoiding Duplication:** Ensure your research is original by knowing what has already been done.
- **Methodological Insights:** Review the methodologies used in previous studies to choose or refine your own approach.
- **Refining Research Questions:** Helps in shaping and refining your research questions and objectives.

Literature Review: Sources

- **Academic Journals:** These are the primary sources of peer-reviewed research articles. Key finance journals include the Journal of Finance, Journal of Financial Economics, and Review of Financial Studies.
- **Books and Book Chapters:** Useful for comprehensive coverage of a topic, historical data, or theoretical models.
- **Working Papers and Conference Papers:** Often contain the latest research and innovative methodologies.
- **Dissertations and Theses:** Can provide detailed case studies and examples of previous research trajectories.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

1. Define Your Research Question

- **Specificity:** Start with a clear, well-defined research question. The more specific your question, the more focused your search can be.
- **Keywords:** Identify the main concepts and variables in your research question and list all possible synonyms, related terms, and acronyms.

2. Choose the Right Databases and Resources

- **Subject-Specific Databases:** Use databases specific to finance and economics, such as EconLit, JSTOR, and the Social Science Research Network (SSRN). For broader searches, Google Scholar and Scopus are useful.
- **Library Catalogs:** Don't overlook books, reports, and theses which can be found in university library catalogs.
- **Professional Publications:** Include searches in professional journals and publications like those from the American Finance Association or financial think tanks.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

3. Develop Search Strategies

- **Boolean Operators:** Use Boolean operators (AND, OR, NOT) to combine or exclude keywords and refine your search results.
 - ESG **AND** stock returns
 - Stock returns **OR** share performance
 - Stock returns **NOT** bonds
- **Truncation and Wildcards:** Use truncation symbols (e.g., econom* to cover economy, economics, economist) and wildcards (e.g., wom?n to find woman or women) to broaden your searches.
- **Phrase Searching:** Use quotation marks to search for exact phrases, which is especially useful for searching specific theories or concepts (e.g., "efficient market hypothesis").
- **Filed Searching:** Limit your search to specific fields, such as title, abstract, author, or publication year.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

4. Utilize Advanced Search Features

- **Filters and Facets:** Many databases allow you to filter results by date, publication type, subject area, etc. Use these features to narrow down your search.
- **Subject Headings:** Use databases' controlled vocabularies or subject headings to find all articles categorized under specific terms. For example, EconLit uses subject headings based on the Journal of Economic Literature (JEL) classification system. You can use specific JEL codes to find relevant articles if you're researching topics like corporate finance or financial markets.
- **Backward Citation:** Start with a highly relevant paper and look at its references to find earlier research on the topic.
- **Forward Citation:** See who has cited a key paper since its publication. This helps identify recent research that builds on or challenges the original study.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

5. Evaluate and Select Sources

- **Relevance:** Read abstracts to assess the relevance of the content to your research question.
- **Quality:** Prioritize peer-reviewed journal articles and reputable sources over others.
- **Citations:** Check how many times a paper has been cited to gauge its impact and significance in the field.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

6. Organize and Manage Your Literature

- **Reference Management Software:** Use tools like Zotero, EndNote, or Mendeley to keep track of your searches, store articles, and manage citations.
- **Note-Taking:** Develop a consistent method for taking notes and summarizing findings. Include bibliographic information and your thoughts on the relevance and quality of the research.

7. Stay Updated

- **Alerts and RSS Feeds:** Set up alerts in databases for your key search terms to receive updates when new articles are published.
- **Networking:** Engage with other researchers in your field through conferences, workshops, and online forums. They can offer insights into sources and new developments.

Literature Review: Effective Search Skills

8. Review and Iterate

- **Iterative Process:** Literature search is not a one-time task but a continuous part of your research process. Review and refine your search terms and strategies as you gain more insights into your topic.
- **Feedback:** Discuss your search strategies and findings with peers or mentors. They can provide valuable feedback and suggest additional resources or angles you might have missed.

Literature Review: Conducting the Review

- **Critical Analysis:** Evaluate the relevance, quality, and contributions of each source. Look for contradictions, methodological limitations, and areas of consensus.
- **Synthesis:** Combine information from various sources to present a coherent narrative. Highlight trends in the research, major debates, and emerging questions.
 - ❑ *Synthesize, don't just summarize the literature!*
- **Summaries of Each Article:** Briefly summarize key points, findings, and methodologies.

Literature Review: Documenting the Review

- **Example Entry:**
 - **Citation:** Author(s), (Year). Title of the article. Journal Name, Volume(Issue), Page numbers.
 - **Summary:** This article examines the impact of corporate governance practices on firm performance in emerging markets. The authors use a sample of 500 firms and find that stronger governance is associated with better financial performance.
 - **Evaluation:** The study's use of a large sample size strengthens its findings. However, its reliance on secondary data may introduce biases. The focus on emerging markets makes it highly relevant to my research.
 - **Reflection:** This source provides valuable insights into the relationship between governance and performance, supporting my hypothesis on the importance of governance practices.

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

- **Critically evaluating** past research is an essential skill for any academic, particularly in fields like finance where theories and models continually evolve. This evaluation allows you to establish a solid framework for your research, identify gaps in the literature, and ensure that your study contributes valuable new insights.
- **Methodological Evaluation:** Assess the strengths and weaknesses of the research methods used in the studies you review.
- **Theoretical Critique:** Evaluate the theoretical foundations of the studies. Are there biases or assumptions that need addressing?
- **Empirical Adequacy:** Consider the adequacy and reliability of the data used in previous studies.

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

1. Assessing the Credibility of the Source

- **Author Credentials:** reputation of the authors. Are they well-regarded in their field?
- **Publication Source:** Check the impact factor and reputation of the journal or conference where the research was published. Peer-reviewed sources generally offer a higher level of credibility.
- **Citation Analysis:** Check how frequently a study has been cited by others in the field.

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

2. Analyzing the Research Design

- **Methodological Rigor:** Assess the appropriateness and execution of the research methodology. Was the study design suitable for the research question? Were the statistical analyses performed correctly?
- **Sample Size and Selection:** Look at the sample size and selection criteria. Was the sample size adequate to support the conclusions? Were there any biases in how participants or data points were selected?
- **Data and Measurement:** evaluate the quality of the data used. Are the variables measured accurately and consistently?
- **Controls and Variables:** Consider how well the study controlled for confounding variables. Were there potential variables that were not accounted for that might affect the results?

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

3. Evaluating the Findings and Conclusions

- **Relevance and Significance:** Determine the relevance of the findings to the current research question. Are the results significant? Do they add new insights or challenge existing theories?
- **Consistency:** Compare the findings with other studies on the same topic. Are they consistent with other research, or do they contradict existing evidence? How are discrepancies explained?
- **Generalizability:** Consider whether the results are generalizable to other settings or populations. Are the conclusions drawn too broadly from a specific sample?

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

4. Looking for Replication and Transparency

- **Replication Studies:** Check if there have been any replication attempts. Replication can confirm the reliability of results and is a critical aspect of scientific research.
- **Data and Code Availability:** Assess whether the researchers have made their data and coding available for review. Transparency in data and methods enhances credibility and allows for a deeper evaluation of the findings.

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

5. Critiquing the Discussion and Interpretation

- **Alternative Explanations:** Evaluate whether the authors have considered alternative interpretations of their data. A robust discussion should acknowledge other possible explanations.
- **Limitations:** Check if the authors have discussed the limitations of their study openly and thoroughly. Acknowledging limitations is a sign of rigorous and honest research.
- **Implications:** Consider the practical implications of the research. Do the authors provide insights into how their findings can be applied in real-world settings?

Literature Review: Critical Evaluation

6. Synthesizing the Evaluation

- **Overall Contribution:** Weigh all the above elements to determine the research's overall contribution to the field. Does it advance knowledge, offer practical solutions, or open new areas for investigation?
- **Writing a Critical Review:** When writing your own literature review, use the information from your critical evaluation to support your discussion of how your research fits into the existing body of knowledge.

Literature Review: Writing the Review

- **Introduction:** Set up the purpose of the review; define the scope.
- **Body:** Organize the literature into themes or debates. Discuss each in detail, using evidence from your sources.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the main findings, note the gaps in the literature, and explicitly state how your research will address these gaps.

Literature Review: Maintaining Objectivity

- Keep a balanced view by acknowledging the contributions as well as the limitations of the studies reviewed.
- Ensure your own biases or preconceptions do not overshadow the analysis.



**Formulating
Research
Questions**



Formulating Research Questions

1. Focus on the Gaps

- Once you've identified a gap, start to ask questions about it. What hasn't been answered? Why might these questions be important? What could be learned by investigating these areas?

2. Relevance and Originality

- Ensure that your questions are both relevant to the field and original. They should contribute new knowledge or insights and not merely duplicate existing research.

3. Feasibility

- Consider whether the questions can realistically be answered with the resources and time available to you. You may need access to specific data sets, tools, or expertise.

Formulating Research Questions

4. Clarity and Specificity

- Research questions should be clear and specific. A good research question guides your study design and helps you maintain a clear focus throughout your research process.

5. Alignment with Theoretical Frameworks

- Your questions should align with theoretical frameworks in your field. This alignment ensures that your research contributes to the broader academic dialogue in finance.

What is a Big Question?

- A question that is of interest to a broad audience
- A question that is topical
- A question that will be of interest to your employer

What is a Bad Question?

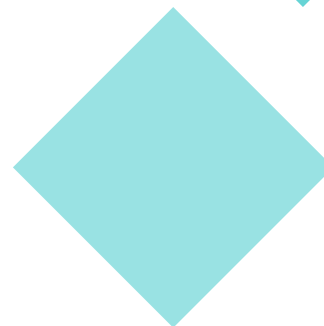
- Not interesting, not relevant
- Not challenging prior beliefs and knowledge
- Not topical
- Answer already in or easily deduced from extant literature
- Unclear and badly structured

Finding a Research Topic?

- Ask yourself the following questions:
 - What area of research I am interested in?
 - Knowledge - exposed to problem or enjoyed topic developed in course/seminar/paper
 - Current issue/controversy/debate
 - Career enhancement or further academic qualifications
 - Sponsored research
 - Do data exist or can be feasibly acquired?
 - Do I know enough about the topic to start?
 - If no - review the literature to expand knowledge on the issue and find gaps



**Data Collection
and Management**



Research Design

- **Purpose:** Designing your study involves deciding how you will collect and analyze data to answer your research questions. This includes:
 - Choosing a research methodology (quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods).
 - Deciding on the data collection methods (surveys, experiments, secondary data analysis, etc.).
- Develop a detailed plan that outlines the procedures for collecting and analyzing data.

Data Collection and Management

1. Data Collection Methods

- **Primary Data:** Sometimes, researchers need to collect primary data through surveys, interviews, or experiments, particularly in behavioral finance studies. This involves designing survey instruments, conducting interviews, or setting up experimental protocols.
- **Secondary Data:** *Most finance research utilizes secondary data*, which includes financial statements, stock prices, economic indicators, and market data. Reliable sources like Bloomberg, Thomson Reuters, and government databases are crucial.

Data Collection and Management

2. Data Sources

- **Public Databases I:** Use publicly available databases such as Datastream, CRSP (Center for Research in Security Prices), WRDS (Wharton Research Data Services) for accessing historical financial data.
- **Public Databases II:** Data from academic researchers

Kenneth French FF data:

https://mba.tuck.dartmouth.edu/pages/faculty/ken.french/data_library.html

The Hou-Xue-Zhang factor database: <https://global-q.org/index.html>

<http://www.globalfactorpremia.org/>

<https://sites.google.com/site/chenandrewy/>

<https://jkpfactors.com/>

- Data from practitioners: AQR (<https://www.aqr.com/Insights/Datasets>)
- Data made available from academic authors specific to published papers

Data Collection and Management

2. Data Sources

- **Proprietary Data:** Some data sets, especially those providing high-frequency trading data or detailed consumer finance records, are proprietary and require subscriptions or specific agreements to access.
- **Qualitative Data:** Sources might include interviews with finance professionals, policymakers, or minutes from central bank meetings.

Data Collection and Management

3. Data Cleaning and Preparation

- **Data Scrubbing:** This involves correcting inaccuracies, filling missing values, and smoothing out noise in the data to ensure reliability and accuracy for analysis.
- **Data Transformation:** Transforming data into a usable format, such as adjusting all financial figures to a common currency or scaling data points for comparability.
- **Handling Missing Data:** Employing statistical methods or machine learning techniques to handle missing data appropriately, ensuring that the analysis remains robust.

Data Collection and Management

4. Data Management

- **Data Storage:** Secure and structured data storage is crucial, especially for large datasets. Cloud services like AWS or Google Cloud can be used for scalable and secure data storage.
- **Data Security:** Ensuring data privacy and security, especially with sensitive information, through encryption, secure access protocols, and compliance with regulations like GDPR for data involving individuals.

Data Collection and Management

5. Data Analysis Tools

- **Statistical and Econometric Software:** Tools such as R, Python, Stata, Eviews and MATLAB are widely used for statistical analysis and econometric modelling in finance.
- **Data Visualization Tools:** Software like Tableau, Power BI, or even libraries in Python (like matplotlib or seaborn) help in visualizing complex datasets to identify trends and patterns.

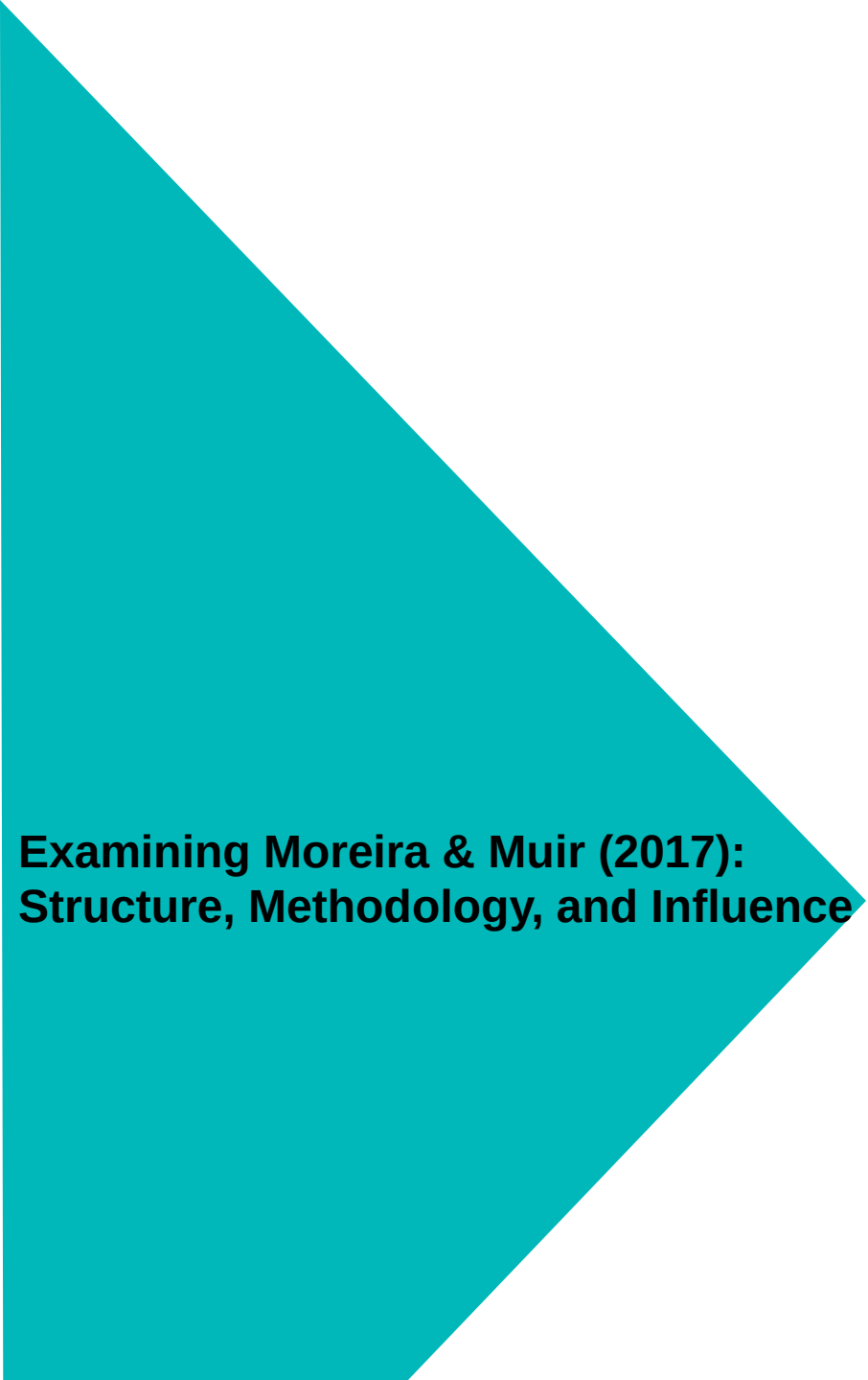
Data Collection and Management

6. Documentation and Metadata

- **Creating Metadata:** Develop comprehensive metadata for datasets, which includes information about the data origin, methodology used for collection, and any transformations the data has undergone.
- **Research Documentation:** Keeping detailed records of data collection and analysis processes to ensure reproducibility and integrity of the research.

7. Legal Compliance

- **Data Use Agreements:** Be aware of and comply with any data use agreements, especially when using proprietary or sensitive data.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Ensure compliance with all relevant financial and data protection regulations, which may vary by country or region.

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**Examining Moreira & Muir (2017):
Structure, Methodology, and Influence**

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**Case Study:
From Theory to
Practice in
Finance
Research**

Structure and Contribution

Moreira, A., Muir, T., 2017. Volatility-Managed Portfolios. The Journal of Finance.

- **Research question:** Can portfolios with volatility-scaled exposure outperform static strategies?
- **Motivation:** Markets exhibit time-varying volatility → static factor exposures may be suboptimal.
- **Structure of the paper:**
 - Intro & motivation (risk-adjusted returns and predictability)
 - Data & methodology (factor strategies, volatility scaling)
 - Empirical results (Sharpe ratios, alphas)
 - Robustness checks (transaction costs, leverage, alternative models)
- **Contribution:** Proposes volatility-managed factor portfolios; challenges assumptions of static exposure.

Methodology & Findings

- **Data:**

- US equity factor premia (market, SMB, HML, momentum, etc.)
- FX carry factor, credit spreads, international indices (appendix)

- **Method:**

- Scale portfolio returns by inverse of lagged variance:

$$r_{vm,t} = \frac{c}{\hat{\sigma}_{t-1}^2} r_t$$

- Compare volatility-managed portfolios vs. buy-and-hold.

- **Findings:**

- Higher Sharpe ratios than static strategies.
- Positive alphas after controlling for standard risk factors.
- Results robust to costs and alternative risk explanations (multifactor risk, tail risk, downside market risk, or more exposure to volatility shocks).

Volatility Managed Portfolios: Results

Panel A: Univariate Regressions

	(1) Mkt $^{\sigma}$	(2) SMB $^{\sigma}$	(3) HML $^{\sigma}$	(4) Mom $^{\sigma}$	(5) RMW $^{\sigma}$	(6) CMA $^{\sigma}$	(7) FX $^{\sigma}$	(8) ROE $^{\sigma}$	(9) IA $^{\sigma}$	(10) BAB $^{\sigma}$
MktRF	0.61 (0.05)									
SMB		0.62 (0.08)								
HML			0.57 (0.07)							
Mom				0.47 (0.07)						
RMW					0.62 (0.08)					
CMA						0.68 (0.05)				
Carry							0.71 (0.08)			
ROE								0.63 (0.07)		
IA									0.68 (0.05)	
BAB										0.57 (0.05)
Alpha (α)	4.86 (1.56)	-0.58 (0.91)	1.97 (1.02)	12.51 (1.71)	2.44 (0.83)	0.38 (0.67)	2.78 (1.49)	5.48 (0.97)	1.55 (0.67)	5.67 (0.98)
N	1,065	1,065	1,065	1,060	621	621	360	575	575	996
R^2	0.37	0.38	0.32	0.22	0.38	0.46	0.33	0.40	0.47	0.33
RMSE	51.39	30.44	34.92	50.37	20.16	17.55	25.34	23.69	16.58	29.73

Panel B: Alphas Controlling for Fama-French Three Factors

Alpha (α)	5.45 (1.56)	-0.33 (0.89)	2.66 (1.02)	10.52 (1.60)	3.18 (0.83)	-0.01 (0.68)	2.54 (1.65)	5.76 (0.97)	1.14 (0.69)	5.63 (0.97)
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Impact & Extensions

- Influence on later research:
 - Look-ahead bias when calculating c (Liu et al., 2019).
 - In vs. out of sample evidence (Cederburg et al. 2020).
 - Studies of transaction costs, short-selling, and arbitrage (Barroso & Detzel, 2021).
 - Alternative volatility prediction models (Wang & Yan 2021).
 - Questions about declining profitability post-2001 (Angelidis & Tessaromatis 2023).
 - (a) Allow relative weight on each factor to vary with market volatility (b) optimize for transaction costs with trading diversification across factors (DeMiguel, Martin-Utrera, and Uppal, 2024).
- Broader impact:
 - Opened new line of research on volatility timing.
 - Inspired practical applications in risk management and asset allocation.

2. Writing and Presenting Findings



What is an Academic Paper?

- **Purpose:** Your research findings are presented in a structured format, typically as a dissertation or research paper.
 - The goal is to communicate your findings clearly and persuasively.
- States in simple language what the question is, how you answer it, and why it's worth taking it seriously.
- Includes only original writing, i.e., your own.
- Describes the execution and results.
- Supports the presentation of results with tables and figures of your own design.
- Summarizes and concludes the main takeaways in simple language.

Structure of an Academic Paper

1. **Title:** Clear and concise, indicating the main focus of the research.
2. **Abstract:** A succinct summary of the key points of your paper including purpose, methodology, results, and conclusions.
3. **Introduction:** Sets the stage by introducing the topic, stating the research problem, and outlining the paper's structure.
4. **Literature Review:** Demonstrates a thorough understanding of the existing research and establishes the gap your study addresses; often inside of introduction.
5. **Methodology and Data:** Clearly describes the research design, data collection, and analysis methods.

Structure of an Academic Paper

6. **Results:** Presents the findings of the study in an organized manner, using tables, graphs, and statistical evidence.
7. **Discussion:** Interprets the results, explains their implications, and how they relate to existing knowledge.
8. **Conclusion:** Summarizes the research, its contributions, limitations, and suggests areas for future research.
9. **References:** Lists all sources cited in the paper in a consistent format, following relevant style guides (e.g., APA, Chicago).
10. **Appendices**
11. **Tables and figures**

Structure of an Academic Paper

1. Title

- The title should be:
 - Concise, descriptive, and capture the essence of the research project
 - Clearly communicate the focus of the research
- It sets the tone and gives the first impression of your study.
- Careful use of buzzwords or movie titles (Consumption strikes back? Honey, I shrank the covariance matrix)

Structure of an Academic Paper

2. Abstract

- A brief summary of the paper, usually about 100 words, which includes the research question, methodology, and potential contributions of the research.
 - Keep it within the word limit
 - Be clear and concise
 - Avoid jargon and technical terms
 - Ensure it accurately reflects the content of the paper
- You are likely to write many versions of the abstract
 - Once you have completed writing the paper, you revisit the abstract and re-write it as necessary.

Examples of Titles and Abstracts

<https://academic.oup.com/rof/issue/28/6>

<https://afajof.org/most-cited-recent-articles/>

<https://www.tandfonline.com/toc/ufaj20/current>

Structure of an Academic Paper

3. Introduction

- **Context and Background:** Provide a brief overview of the topic and its importance.
- **Research Problem:** Clearly define the problem that your research intends to address.
- **Research Objectives/Questions:** List the objectives or pose the questions that your research aims to answer.
- **Significance of the Study:** Explain how your research will contribute to the field of finance, mention any practical implications, and suggest how it might advance understanding of the topic.

Structure of an Academic Paper

3. Introduction

- The introduction is critical. It is the most important part of the paper.
- The goal is to provide enough information to the reader to understand what you do in the paper without reading the paper in full.
- The introduction is usually 3-4 pages long.
- *It must be the last section to be written.*

Structure of an Academic Paper

3. Introduction: An example

Structure of an Academic Paper

4. Literature Review

- Goals: to bring the reader up to date with what has been done already; explain to the reader where your paper's contribution fits with the existing literature and exactly what it adds that is new; give credit to other authors.
- Explain the main issues and questions addressed in the literature: how has the literature addressed these issues? What are the main results found? Are there any questions to be addressed?
- Be critical (reading with a critical viewpoint, but not negatively; try to formulate constructive comments).
- Never be too trusting (some research may be inaccurate). Few papers or research studies are perfect. Good papers have both strengths and weaknesses.
- An ongoing process: During the topic selection, before the analysis, during the analysis, during the actual write-up, and after you write the conclusions.

Structure of an Academic Paper

5. Methodology and Hypotheses

- These could be subsections of the literature review or stand-alone sections.
- First, you need to formally state your hypotheses (i.e., convert your research problem to a testable claim)
- Next, you need to find the appropriate method (statistical or else) to test your claim.

Common Errors

- Constructing hypotheses that do not match your research problem
- Statistical tests do not match your hypotheses
 - Using a t-test when your hypothesis is that returns are non-normal
 - Using a linear model when your hypothesis is that the relationship is non-linear
- Assumptions of the methods do not coincide with the nature of your research problem.
 - Use of OLS regression for a research problem characterized by non-linear relationships, heteroscedasticity, and autocorrelation.

Structure of an Academic Paper

6. Data

- Specify the source, time period, how collected, definitions of variables, etc.
- Include a table of summary statistics.
- Summarize graphically the data if appropriate.
- In some cases, for very specific data, you may want to have an Appendix that contains this data or a portion of it.

Structure of an Academic Paper

6. Data

- Reliability, accuracy, and up-to-date
 - A reliable source in which one can be confident of the data accuracy. Use the most recent data, incorporating the latest revisions.
- Relevance
 - The data should closely approximate the concept it aims to measure and exhibit any expected characteristics (dividends versus earnings for measuring cash flows).
- Consistency
 - Data should be consistently defined for all observations in a series (definition may have changed over time).
- Appropriate length
 - Use the maximum number of observations - increasing the number of observations should enhance statistical inference.
 - However, this is only true if all the data is from a period pertinent to the relationship under study. For example, using data from a period of fixed exchange rates will not be informative in characterizing exchange rate movements under a floating regime.

Structure of an Academic Paper

6. Data Structures

- **Cross-section** data
 - Observations are drawn from a common time period across different groupings or categories such as countries, regions, households, firms.
 - Survey data is often collected in a single time period and is, therefore, cross-sectional in nature.
- **Time-series** data are observations drawn at regular time intervals in a chronological sequence.
 - Typical frequencies (periodicity) of time-series drawings are annual, quarterly, monthly, daily, intra-day.
 - Necessary for dynamic modelling (the adjustment of a variable to itself or another variable through time), forecasting (projections of future values of variables)
- **Panel** data draws observations on variables both across groupings and through time - a combination of cross-section and time-series data (e.g. returns or earnings of individual firms over several years).

Structure of an Academic Paper

6. Issues with Data Sources

- Data definitions can vary across (and within) publications.
 - Changing definitions; variable definition has changed.
 - Changing geographic areas, e.g., Unified Germany
- Data revision is when recent editions of a publication report different observations for a particular variable than previously.
 - Preliminary estimates based upon partial information. Likely to be subject to revision.
- Missing Data (linear interpolation). This method assumes a variable grows steadily, which may not be appropriate for a volatile series. More sophisticated statistical techniques are needed.
- Extraneous information
 - Correction based on similar series or informed judgment about its value based upon relevant information.

Structure of an Academic Paper

7. Section on Empirical Analysis

- Describe the different tests and results of the tests.
- Discuss the results in relation to the issues you are analyzing.
- May have subsections on different results.
- Relate the results to earlier sections, in particular the theory and existing literature.
- In this section, you should only include summary tables of the results, as few of them as possible. Only the results necessary for your discussion should be in the main text. Details and alternative calculations should be put in appendices.

Structure of an Academic Paper

8. Writing the Conclusion

- Provide a good summary of your findings
 - Summarize the issue you investigated, how you did it, and what your results are. What are the implications of your results for researchers, practitioners, and policymakers?
- State the limitations and shortcomings of your study or results
 - If you were limited by your data, explain how you think this might affect the generality of your conclusions.
 - Do not underrate your work, but do not claim to have solved problems that are not firmly substantiated in the body of the thesis.
- You don't need to sell your results here, that was done in the introduction
- Provide directions for future research
 - Address shortcomings if data were available or investigate further some issues. Theoretical issues raised by your empirical results.

Structure of an Academic Paper

9. Bibliography

- Make sure every referenced item in the text is listed in this section
- Make sure that there is no item on the list that is unreferenced in the text. If you list it, you must have used it somewhere.
- Make sure you comply with standards (EDHEC format for theses if any).
- The list of literature must not be grouped in books, articles etc., but should be listed alphabetically by author.
- A large number of references does not say anything about the quality of your work. Cite only the relevant literature.

Structure of an Academic Paper

10. Appendices

- The appendix should consist of additional tables, computer printouts, and other documentation.
- The thesis itself should be written in such a way that it can be read independently of the appendix.
- All central figures and tables should be placed, numbered/labelled, and commented upon in the text itself.

Structure of an Academic Paper

11. Tables and Figures

- Tables can be used to provide accurate figures or to summarize information that should otherwise be included in the text.
- Include only tables that you comment on. Be parsimonious. Find ways to include the most information in the table. Decide what should be in rows or columns.
- Tables should be fully explained at the top or bottom of the table (see papers published in the Journal of Finance for models).
- Often figures provide a better way than tables to convey a message (line graphs, bar graphs, pie charts).
- Find ways to save space with figures. More than one graph per page.

Writing and Presenting Findings: Writing Style

- **Clarity and Precision:** Use clear and precise language to explain complex financial concepts. Be specific and accurate in your statements.
- **Formality:** Maintain a formal tone, avoiding colloquialisms and personal language.
- **Objectivity:** Keep the writing objective; focus on the research data and analysis rather than personal opinions.
- **Consistency:** Be consistent in terms of format, style, and terminology.
- **Conciseness:** Eliminate unnecessary words and repetition. Highlight the most important information and insights.

Writing and Presenting Findings: Writing Style

1. Active vs. Passive Voice:

- **Active Voice:** "The researcher conducted the experiment."
- **Passive Voice:** "The experiment was conducted by the researcher."

2. Using Specific Language:

- **General:** "The results were good."
- **Specific:** "The results showed a 15% increase in efficiency."

3. Avoiding Redundancy:

- **Redundant:** "In my opinion, I believe that..."
- **Concise:** "I believe that..."

4. Varying Sentence Structure:

- **Monotonous:** "The study was conducted. The results were analyzed. The conclusions were drawn."
- **Varied:** "After conducting the study, the results were analyzed, leading to the conclusions drawn."

Writing and Presenting Findings: Citation Practices

- **Importance of Citations:** Citations provide the foundation of academic integrity, allowing readers to verify sources and giving credit to original authors, which avoids plagiarism.
- **Common Styles:** Citing sources in finance journals typically follows specific citation styles, often depending on the journal's guidelines. However, many finance journals use variations of common citation styles like APA, Chicago, or Harvard.

- **Journal of Finance Style**

https://afajof.org/wp-content/uploads/files/policies-and-guidelines/JF_Style_-_February_2017.pdf

- **Journal of Financial Economics**

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/journal/journal-of-financial-economics/publish/guide-for-authors>

Writing and Presenting Findings: Using Citations Effectively

- **Direct Quotations:** Use sparingly and only when the original wording is necessary for your argument; always include the page number.
- **Paraphrasing:** This is crucial for integrating evidence into your writing without over-relying on direct quotes. It involves rewriting the source material in your own words and style, but you must still cite the original source.
- **Summarizing:** Useful for condensing broad segments of work into a few sentences that capture the essence of the arguments or findings, requiring a citation.
- **Software Options:** Tools like EndNote, Zotero, and Mendeley can help manage and format citations and bibliographies, saving time and reducing errors.

Writing and Presenting Findings: Avoiding Plagiarism

- **Definition of Plagiarism:** Using someone else's work or ideas without proper attribution.
- **Types of Plagiarism:**
 - **Direct Plagiarism:** Copying text word-for-word.
 - **Self-Plagiarism:** Reusing your own previously published work.
 - **Mosaic Plagiarism:** Piecing together ideas or phrases from different sources.
 - **Accidental Plagiarism:** Unintentionally failing to cite sources correctly.
- **How to Avoid Plagiarism:**
 - **Proper Citation; Paraphrasing; Quotations;**
 - **Reference Management:** Use tools like EndNote or Mendeley to manage citations.
 - **Plagiarism Detection Tools:** Use software like Turnitin or Grammarly to check for plagiarism.

Writing and Presenting Findings: Editing and Proofreading

- Regularly review and revise your draft to improve clarity and coherence.
- Check for grammatical errors and typos.
- Ensure all citations and references are formatted correctly.
 - A poorly formatted draft is a sign that:
 - you don't care about your reader;
 - you don't read enough, because almost all papers worth reading are well formatted.
 - you made no effort in re-reading what you wrote after the first pass.
 - ADOPT the same formatting style as a good academic paper you have read: they already conform to the standards.
- Consider using software tools like **Grammarly**, or services like **Scribbr** for professional editing.

Presentation: Designing the Presentation

- **Understand Your Audience:** Tailor your presentation to the knowledge level and interests of your audience. For example, what you present and how you present it will differ if you are speaking to industry professionals versus fellow researchers or a general public audience.

Presentation: Designing the Presentation

- **Structure:** Similar to the paper, include an introduction, body (methodology, results), and conclusion.
 - **Introduction:** Briefly introduce your topic, state the research question, and explain why it's important.
 - **Methodology:** Outline how you conducted your research. Be succinct but provide enough detail to validate your approach.
 - **Results:** Present the main findings. Use visual aids like charts, graphs, and tables to make complex data easier to understand.
 - **Discussion:** Interpret the results, discuss their implications, and how they fit with existing knowledge.
 - **Conclusion:** Summarize the key points and suggest future research directions or practical applications.

Presentation: Introduction

Motivation

- Anecdotes
- Facts
- Policy questions

This paper

- Outline what your paper does and why.

Preview of findings

- Be clear and concise
- Explain enough of your methodology to avoid appearing like magic but
- not so much that it overshadows the findings.

Presentation: Model

Provide sources of each variable

- Clearly identify the source of each variable to avoid confusion later.

Proactively address concerns about data accuracy and measurement

- Are the data sources trustworthy?
- Confirm that the concepts being measured align with those in your model.

Be sure to take credit for

- Introducing novel data
- Innovating new measurement techniques
- Uncovering new sources of variation

Remember: no one cares about your challenges or how long it took to download the data.

Presentation: Model

- Be explicit: write down and explain the estimated model.
- Avoid presenting a full derivation of your model unless this is the main focus of your paper.
- Does your model provide a good approximation?
- How would you assess the plausibility of your assumptions?
- Try to anticipate possible criticism.

Presentation: Designing the Presentation

- **Slides:** Create clear and visually appealing slides. Use bullet points to highlight key facts; avoid overcrowding slides with text.
- **Visual Aids:** Effectively present data using **graphs, charts, and tables**. Tools like PowerPoint, Prezi, or Canva can be used to design engaging presentations.
 - **Clarity:** Make sure all visual aids are clear and visible to the entire audience. Avoid cluttering slides with too much information.
 - **Relevance:** Each visual should be directly relevant to the content discussed. Irrelevant visuals can distract from the key message. Don't put anything on a slide you don't plan to discuss.
 - **Professionalism:** Use a consistent and professional style throughout your presentation materials, including fonts, colors, and layouts.

Presentation: Delivery Techniques

- **Engaging Delivery:**
 - **Pace:** Speak clearly and at a pace that allows the audience to absorb the information. Avoid rushing through your presentation.
 - **Tone:** Maintain a formal yet approachable tone. Modulate your voice to emphasize important points and keep the audience engaged.
 - **Interaction:** If the format allows, encourage questions and interactions. This can help clarify points and increase audience engagement.
- **Rehearsing:** Practice your presentation multiple times to ensure smooth delivery. *Time your presentation to avoid rushing through slides.*
- **Handling Questions:** Prepare to answer questions from your audience. Practice responding to potential questions in your research.

Presentation: Using Technology

- **Presentation Tools:** Familiarize yourself with the technical aspects of presentation tools. Ensure that videos or interactive elements function correctly.
- **Remote Presentations:** For online presentations, check your internet connection, sound quality, and video settings. Utilize features like screen sharing effectively.

**PhD Student
Presentations**

PhD Student Presentations End of Years 2 and 3

- The PhD student presentations is an annual event in which second and third-year PhD students do a 35-minute presentation of one of their research papers toward their thesis.
- The goals of the PhD presentation are:
 - Allow students to pitch their research ideas to the whole EDHEC Finance Faculty.
 - Present the main research questions, data, methodology, and expected output.
 - Prepare students for their thesis defense.

PhD Student Presentations End of Years 2 and 3

- Students must complete two presentations by the end of years 2 and 3. Each presentation involves the following steps:
 1. Students sent a presentation draft to their supervisors a month before the research presentation series.
 2. The supervisor notifies the PhD office if the student is ready to present
 3. The student should take note of all comments, suggestions, or questions from seminar participants.
 4. A week after the presentation, each student has to submit a one-page report to the supervisor and the PhD office with the following structure:
 - a. A brief list summarizing the main comments or reactions of the audience
 - b. A brief reply to each comment.
 - c. Action points resulting from the comments and suggestions

PhD Student Presentations End of Years 2 and 3

Assessment

- The Supervisor, Program Director, and Academic Director will evaluate the presentations based on two criteria:
 1. Originality of the research question and appropriateness of the chosen research design.
 2. Effectiveness of the student's communication regarding the relevance of the research and appropriateness of the execution.

3. The Research Proposal



The Research Proposal

- Designing a research proposal involves clearly articulating a research question, detailing the methodology, and explaining the significance of the research.
- A research proposal aims to convince others (e.g., academic supervisors, the PhD directors) that you have a worthwhile research project and that you have the competence and a solid plan to complete it.

The Research Proposal - Components

- 1. Title**
- 2. Abstract**
- 3. Introduction**
- 4. Literature Review**
- 5. Methodology**
- 6. Expected Results**
- 7. Timeline**
- 8. References**
- 9. Appendices**

Why a Research Proposal

- A research proposal is a brief statement of what you intend to research, why and how.
- It is important because the proposal:
 - Help the PhD program directors understand “where you are”
 - Provides important information on whether your proposed research is:
 - Interesting
 - Original
 - Viable
 - Help the PhD program directors match you with the right adviser
 - Help you understand what you want to do

The Research Proposal - Components

1. Title

- The title should be concise, descriptive, and capture the essence of the research project. It sets the tone and gives the first impression of your study.

2. Abstract

- A brief summary of the proposal, usually about 100 words, which includes the research question, methodology, and potential research contributions.
 - Keep it within the word limit.
 - Be clear and concise.
 - Avoid jargon and technical terms.
 - Ensure it accurately reflects the content of the paper.

The Research Proposal - Components

3. Introduction

- **Context and Background:** Provide a brief overview of the topic and its importance.
- **Research Problem:** Clearly define the problem that your research intends to address.
- **Research Objectives/Questions:** List the objectives or pose the questions that your research aims to answer.
- **Significance of the Study:** Explain how your research will contribute to the field of finance, mention any practical implications, and suggest how it might advance understanding of the topic.

The Research Proposal - Components

4. Literature Review

- **Context and Framework:** Demonstrates familiarity with existing research on the topic and identifies gaps or controversies your study will address. Critically evaluate past research, highlighting the strengths and weaknesses of previous studies.
- **Theoretical Foundation:** Discusses the theories and models that underpin your research approach. Position your research within the existing body of knowledge, indicating clearly how your research will contribute or build on these studies.

The Research Proposal - Components

5. Research Methodology

- **Design:** Describes the type of research (quantitative, qualitative, experimental, etc.).
- **Data Collection:** Details how data will be collected (surveys, interviews, experiments, secondary data sources) and any instruments or tools that will be used.
- **Data Analysis:** Explains the techniques and procedures for analyzing the collected data, including statistical software or frameworks that will be utilized.
- **Feasibility:** This demonstrates that the proposed methodology is practical and that the research can be completed within the stipulated timeline and resources.

The Research Proposal - Components

6. Expected Results

- **Outcomes:** Discusses the anticipated results and their potential implications.
- **Contribution:** Highlights how these results will contribute to knowledge, policy, or practice in the field.

7. Timeline

- **Schedule:** Provides a detailed timeline for each phase of the research project, ensuring that the project is manageable and can be completed in the allotted time.

8. References

- **Citations:** Lists all academic works and sources cited in the proposal in a consistent and appropriate format.

9. Appendices

- **Supporting Documents:** May include letters of support, additional data, or detailed technical information and calculations.

The Research Proposal –Additional Tips

- **Clarity and Precision:** Make sure each section of the proposal clearly communicates your plans and intentions. Avoid ambiguity.
- **Feasibility:** Ensure that your research proposal is realistic and manageable within the constraints of time, resources, and your current skill set.
- **Alignment:** Each component of your proposal should align with the others to present a cohesive research plan. Your methodology should be clearly capable of answering your research questions, and your literature review should support the relevance and necessity of your study.
- **Impact:** Emphasize the potential impact of your research. Whether it's filling a critical gap in the literature or applying a new theoretical framework to solve an existing problem, make the significance clear.
- **Peer Feedback:** Before finalizing your proposal, seek feedback from peers, mentors, or advisors. This can provide you with valuable insights and help you refine your proposal.

The Research Proposal –Important Dates

- Research Question + Advisors Wishlist: **Monday 4 May 2026**
- Research Proposal Submission: **Friday 21 August 2026 (tbc)**

4. The PhD Defence Process at EDHEC



The PhD Defence Process at EDHEC

- PhD in Finance candidates should submit their finalized dissertation to their advisor a minimum of three months before the planned defense.
- To submit her/his dissertation, a student must have completed all other degree requirements (i.e., obtained an average of B or above in the core courses, passed all comprehensive exams, met the elective coursework requirement, and stayed on course with his/her dissertation work).
- The defense will be scheduled when the dissertation advisor, the program director, and the external dissertation advisor will have signified that, in their judgment, the dissertation is acceptable enough to warrant a defense and final examination.
- The oral defense consists of a forty-minute presentation and twenty minutes of questions from the PhD defense committee.
- Make sure:
 - discuss your presentation with your supervisor before the defense meeting.
 - Answer any comments/questions raised by the external examiner.

The PhD Defence Process at EDHEC

- At the end of the oral defence, the defence committee will decide whether the dissertation is deemed acceptable subject to minor revisions (S), acceptable subject to major revisions (I), or unacceptable (U).
- If a candidate receives an I on her/his dissertation, s/he will have a minimum of three months and a maximum of one year to submit a dissertation revised according to specifications of the revisions subcommittee assembled by the Chair of the Defence Committee with the approval of the Programme Academic Director.
- If the revised dissertation is approved by the revisions subcommittee, the grade on the dissertation is changed to acceptable (S).
- If the revised dissertation is rejected, the grade on the dissertation is changed to unacceptable (U), the candidate is not recommended for the degree, and s/he becomes ineligible to continue in the program.

5. Some Practical Advice and Tools For Doing Research



How to Use Chat GPT in Your Research

- **Literature Review and Research Ideas**
 - Summarizing and synthesizing literature.
 - Generating research questions and hypotheses.
 - Identifying gaps and emerging trends.
- **Data Analysis and Interpretation**
 - Explaining complex financial models and concepts.
 - Assisting with statistical analysis and coding.
 - Interpreting results and providing context.
- **Writing and Presentation**
 - Structuring and organizing research papers.
 - Enhancing clarity and coherence in writing.
 - Creating compelling presentations.

Generative AI for Economic Research: Use Cases and Implications for Economists
<https://www.genaiforecon.org/use-cases.html>

Tools for Doing Research (courtesy of ChatGPT!)

1. Reference Management Software:

- **Zotero**: Helps manage references, organize sources, and create citations.
- **Mendeley**: Offers similar features to Zotero with additional social networking functionalities.
- **EndNote**: A comprehensive reference manager with advanced features for organizing and citing sources.

2. LaTeX for Document Preparation:

- **Overleaf**: An online LaTeX editor with real-time collaboration features, ideal for writing academic documents including dissertations.
- **TeXShop**: A LaTeX editor for macOS, providing a user-friendly interface for writing and compiling LaTeX documents.
- **TeXstudio**: A cross-platform LaTeX editor with features like syntax highlighting, auto-completion, and built-in PDF viewer.

3. Note-Taking and Writing Tools:

- **Evernote**: Allows capturing and organizing notes, ideas, and research materials across devices.
- **OneNote**: Microsoft's note-taking software, great for organizing research notes and collaborating with others.
- **Scrivener**: Writing software designed for long documents like dissertations, offering organization and outlining features.

Tools for Doing Research (courtesy of ChatGPT!)

4. Python for Data Analysis:

- **Jupyter Notebook:** Interactive computing environment for creating and sharing documents containing live code, equations, visualizations, and narrative text.
- **Pandas:** Python library for data manipulation and analysis, particularly useful for handling structured data.
- **NumPy:** Fundamental package for scientific computing with Python, providing support for large, multi-dimensional arrays and matrices.

5. Data Analysis Software:

- **SPSS:** Widely used for statistical analysis in social sciences.
- **R:** A powerful statistical software for data analysis and visualization.
- **NVivo:** Qualitative data analysis software for coding and analyzing textual and multimedia data.
- **Stata:**

6. Project Management Tools:

- **Trello:** Helps organize tasks and research milestones on customizable boards.
- **Asana:** Project management software for tracking tasks, deadlines, and progress.
- **Todoist:** Task management application for organizing to-do lists and setting reminders.

Tools for Doing Research (courtesy of ChatGPT!)

7. Collaboration and Communication Tools:

- **Slack**: Team communication platform for real-time messaging and collaboration.
- **Google Workspace (formerly G Suite)**: Suite of productivity tools including Gmail, Google Drive, Docs, Sheets, and Hangouts for collaboration and communication.
- **Microsoft Teams**: Collaboration platform integrating chat, video meetings, file sharing, and productivity apps.

8. Grammar and Proofreading Tools:

- **Grammarly**: Grammar checker and writing assistant for improving writing quality and clarity.
- **ProWritingAid**: Comprehensive writing improvement tool offering grammar checking, style suggestions, and readability analysis.
- **Microsoft Word's Grammar and Spelling Check**: Built-in grammar and spelling checker in Microsoft Word for proofreading documents.

9. Visualization Tools:

- **matplotlib/seaborn**: Python libraries for creating static, animated, and interactive visualizations.
- **Tableau**: Data visualization software for creating interactive and shareable visualizations.
- **Gephi**: Network analysis and visualization tool for exploring and understanding complex relationships in data.

Tools for Doing Research (courtesy of ChatGPT!)

10. Backup and Cloud Storage:

- **Dropbox:** Cloud storage service for backing up and accessing research materials from anywhere.
- **Google Drive:** Cloud storage and file synchronization service integrated with Google Workspace for collaborative work and document sharing.
- **OneDrive:** Microsoft's cloud storage service, tightly integrated with Office applications for seamless access and collaboration.

How to Get the Most from your Advisor

- **Open Communication**

- **Regular Meetings:** Schedule regular meetings to discuss your progress, challenges, and plans.
- **Clear Expectations:** Clarify your advisor's expectations and communicate your own goals and expectations.
- **Honesty:** Be honest about your challenges and progress. If you are struggling, let them know early.

- **Professionalism**

- **Punctuality:** Be on time for meetings and meet deadlines.
- **Preparedness:** Come to meetings prepared with updates, questions, and any necessary materials.
- **Respect:** Show respect for their time and expertise.

How to Get the Most from your Advisor

- **Proactive Engagement**

- **Initiative:** Take initiative in your research and propose ideas
- **Responsiveness:** Respond promptly to emails and feedback.
- **Seek Feedback:** Actively seek constructive criticism and act on it.

- **Personal Growth and Independence**

- **Independence:** Demonstrate your ability to work independently and solve problems.
- **Continuous Learning:** Show your commitment to learning and improving your skills.
- **Goal Setting:** Set short-term and long-term goals and share them with your advisor.

How to Get the Most From Your Advisor

- **Handling Conflicts**

- **Address Issues Early:** If conflicts arise, address them early and professionally.
- **Seek Mediation:** If necessary, seek mediation from a third party (directors of the PhD program).
- **Stay Professional:** Keep interactions professional, even during disagreements.

- **Building Trust**

- **Consistency:** Be consistent in your work ethic and communication.
- **Transparency:** Maintain transparency in your research progress and any issues you encounter.

Ethical Considerations in Financial Research

- **Data Integrity:** Ensuring accuracy, reliability, and validity of data.
- **Conflict of Interest:** Disclosing any potential conflicts that could bias the research.
- **Informed Consent:** Ensuring that participants are fully informed about the research and consent voluntarily.
- **Confidentiality:** Protecting the privacy of participants and confidentiality of data.
- **Transparency:** Being open about research methods, data sources, and funding.
- **Responsible Reporting:** Accurate and honest reporting of findings and acknowledging limitations.

Avoiding Research Misconduct

- **Definition of Research Misconduct:** Fabrication, falsification, or plagiarism in proposing, performing, or reviewing research, or in reporting research results.
- **Types of Misconduct:**
 - **Fabrication:** Making up data or results.
 - **Falsification:** Manipulating research materials, equipment, or processes, or changing or omitting data or results.
 - **Plagiarism:** Using another person's ideas, processes, results, or words without giving proper credit.

Avoiding Research Misconduct

- **Consequences of Misconduct:**

- Retraction of published works.
- Damage to professional reputation.
- Legal repercussions.

- **Preventive Measures:**

- Maintain detailed and accurate records of research activities.
- Use plagiarism detection software.
- Foster a culture of integrity and accountability in research environments.

THE END

Thank you for your attention!